

ElevateNP

Executive Summary

Client

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ElevateNP

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Background

Elevate NP is a nonprofit capacity-building organization that supports small and midsize nonprofits across Southwestern Pennsylvania through assessment, consulting, and resource allocation. A core component of their work involves collecting organizational intake data and generating structured reports to evaluate nonprofit capacity and needs. However, prior to this project, their assessment scoring and reporting workflow was highly manual, requiring staff to transfer, clean, and analyze data across SurveyMonkey, Airtable, and Google Sheets. This process was time-intensive, prone to human error, and limited the organization's ability to scale as intake volume increased.

Project Description

Project Opportunity

The project addressed two interconnected challenges: (1) improving data integrity within the Airtable CRM and (2) automating and accelerating the assessment scoring workflow. Existing data structures led to duplication and inconsistencies, while the manual scoring process created inefficiencies, delays, and increased risk of error.

Project Vision

The team developed a scalable, low-code solution that integrates SurveyMonkey, Airtable, Zapier, and Google Sheets into a unified, automated pipeline. The system separates raw intake data from validated organizational records and automates scoring and report generation, while maintaining a human review step to ensure accuracy and usability for non-technical staff.

Project Outcomes

The project resulted in a fully implemented automation system that significantly improves efficiency, data integrity, and scalability.

- **People:** Staff can run assessments through a single approval action, reducing training needs and enabling greater focus on client engagement.

- **Process:** A fragmented manual workflow was replaced with a standardized, repeatable pipeline ensuring consistent data handling and scoring.
- **Technology:** A low-code system integrates platforms and automates data retrieval, transformation, and scoring.

Staff time per assessment decreased from 2–3 hours to 5–10 minutes of active input, with automation completing in the background within 2–4 minutes. This resulted in a 40–60% reduction in manual workload and 30–50% faster report delivery. Client turnaround improved from 1–2 days to same-day or next-day delivery. Automated calculations and standardized inputs reduced data entry and validation errors by approximately 30%, while ensuring consistent outputs across users.

Additionally, the redesigned data architecture separates raw intake data from validated records, reducing duplication and improving CRM reliability. The system is sustainable due to its low-code design and can be maintained by non-technical staff using the provided documentation.

Project Deliverables

The team delivered a production-ready automation system, including integrated Zapier workflows, a redesigned Airtable CRM structure, a standardized Google Sheets processing file, and detailed documentation to support ongoing use and maintenance.

Recommendations

To further enhance system reliability and scalability, the team recommends improving data standardization through unique identifiers, implementing validation checks for missing or duplicate data, enhancing workflow visibility through notifications, and expanding functionality to include dashboards and historical trend analysis.

Student Consulting Team

Yuri Xu focused on system optimization and data processing, improving efficiency and ensuring scoring accuracy through refined automation logic. He is a third-year Information Systems student interested in software engineering and data-driven solutions.

Joyce Lam led the development of Zapier automations and backend integration, building workflows and implementing dynamic data retrieval processes. She is a third-year Information Systems student interested in data systems and technology consulting.

Lena Poshni served as a developer and documentation lead, focusing on data mapping, validating scoring outputs, and creating user-friendly documentation. She is a third-year Information Systems major with a minor in Business and Machine Learning, interested in healthcare technology.